Gracielle Pestana

Staff Product Designer | Product Strategy, UX & Design Systems

Staff-level Product Designer with 15+ years in design and 8+ years specialising in end-to-end product design, research, interaction design, and UI. I turn ambiguous problems and behavioural insights into intuitive, polished experiences, partnering closely with Product and Engineering through prototyping, implementation, and design QA.

My expertise includes design systems, visual craft, UI motion, and AI-assisted prototyping. I have used AI throughout my design practice for three years and am pursuing a Psychology degree to deepen my understanding of user behaviour.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Increased perceived intuitiveness of a complex experience from **5/10 to 8/10**.
- Increased Day 1 retention from **9% to 12%**, representing a **33% relative improvement** through research-led **onboarding optimization**.
- Led product design across live mobile, web, PC, console experiences

SKILLS

Product Design: Growth design, UX strategy, user research, usability testing, onboarding and FTUE, journey mapping, information architecture, interaction design, progressive disclosure, rapid prototyping, A/B testing, Amplitude.

Experimentation & Data: Hypothesis development, behavioural analytics, Firebase, qualitative and quantitative research, product metrics, post-launch analysis, usability experiments, surveys, and benchmarking.

Design Systems & UI: Design systems, component documentation, visual design, responsive UI, motion design, micro-interactions, transitions, iconography.

Leadership: Design direction, designer mentorship, cross-functional facilitation, stakeholder communication, constructive critique, process improvement.

Communication: Fluent English, used daily while collaborating remotely with UK-based cross-functional teams for nearly four years.

AI-Assisted Design: Three years using ChatGPT and Claude to accelerate research synthesis, ideation, content exploration, and rapid prototyping, critically evaluating outputs and turning abstract ideas into tangible experiences.

Tools: Figma, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite, Firebase, Jira, Confluence, Git, ChatGPT, Claude, Proto.io, PlaytestCloud, Perforce.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Product Designer | Auroch Digital
2022 to 2026 (Current)

- Led end-to-end product design for complex core experiences on Mars Horizon 2, creating clarity from ambiguous requirements and aligning user needs, product goals, and technical constraints across design, product, engineering, game design, and marketing.
- Defined and validated interaction strategies through behavioural research, benchmarking, wireframes, rapid prototypes, and usability testing, increasing perceived intuitiveness of a core experience from 5/10 to 8/10.
- Established UX research practices across the project and mentored four Associate and Mid-level designers in usability testing, personas, surveys, research analysis, and evidence-based decision-making.
- Partnered directly with developers from early ideation through implementation and design QA, identifying usability and technical bottlenecks and enabling the team to deliver high-quality experiences efficiently.
- Drove design-system consistency across screens, navigation, HUDs, iconography, documentation, and reusable UI patterns while accommodating the needs of PC, console, and handheld platforms.
- Designed and implemented motion patterns, interface animations, transitions, and feedback states that improved clarity, responsiveness, and the overall quality of the product experience.
- Facilitated cross-disciplinary workshops and design discussions, using prototypes and clear design narratives to align stakeholders and accelerate decisions.

Senior Product Designer | Gazeus Games
2021 to 2022

- Led UX/UI decisions across multiple live digital products, including Buraco Jogatina, Spades, Euchre, and the Jogatina web platform, balancing user experience, engagement objectives, and technical requirements.
- Redesigned a complex onboarding experience using progressive disclosure, usability testing, and post-launch analytics, contributing to a increase of 9% to 12%, representing a 33% relative improvement.
- Led the end-to-end UX and UI process for an achievements and collectibles experience designed to strengthen player progression, reward, engagement, and the visibility of earned cosmetic items.

- Designed the UX for a virtual currency and betting experience for Spades, including daily rewards and rewarded-video journeys, supporting progression and ongoing engagement without owning the economic balancing.
- Used research, surveys, prototypes, usability testing, Firebase data, and product performance insights to identify friction points and guide iterative improvements across multiple products.
- Created and maintained design systems, UI standards, reusable components, iconography, and motion patterns, improving visual consistency across the product portfolio.
- Worked directly with engineering from discovery through Unity implementation, building and optimising interfaces, controls, animations, and interaction feedback using UGUI.
- Conducted an A/B test on two shortlisted CTA labels for Spades' betting feature, with the winning label increasing feature access by 2% compared with the original.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Mid UX/UI Designer at Gazeus Games
2018 to 2021

Marketing Designer at Gazeus Games
2016 to 2018

Technical Designer (Games) at Tamboro Educacional
2014 to 2016

Graphic Designer at 14 Agência de Conteúdo Digital
2013 to 2014

Intern at Sttudio Attila
2012 to 2013

Web Designer at Tamboro Educacional
2011 to 2012

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EDUCATION

Psychology
Estácio, 2026 to 2031

Graphic Design
Senac Rio, 2012 to 2013

LANGUAGES

Portuguese
Native

English
Fluent